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## Video games

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This is just like DVDs and CDs, only the deals often come quicker and with greater discounts. I once picked up a used copy of an Xbox game for \$1.99 that was still selling for \$19.99 in the store. It played perfectly, it still had the manual, and for an extra \$1, I got insurance so if the disc did malfunction I could get a replacement or refund.

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## Cars

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Car experts and sites like Edmunds.com and KBB.com will tell you that brand-new cars lose around 12%–15% of their value the second you drive them off the lot. That's thousands of dollars up in smoke for your average midsize sedan. Why should you take that financial loss? Instead, buy a car that's a year or two old. It will usually have low mileage, a good chunk of the factory warranty left on it, and the depreciation isn't anywhere near as bad for you. That's smart spending.

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## Yard toys

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I encourage my kids to play in the garden, and there are toys and games for them out there. But why buy new when they'll get scuffed up and worn

out in days? Once again, places like CraigsList.org and FreeCycle.org are good places to find some excellent yard toys for the kids. The slide in our backyard was free and has so far lasted three years. It still looks as good as the day we got it (very good in fact), from someone who had previously had it for five years. They're built tough to withstand all weather and all kids.

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## Workout/exercise equipment

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This is an area where you can monopolize on impulse buying and laziness. People will buy a big treadmill, a health rider, an exercise bike, or a weight bench in hopes of getting super-fit and ultra-trim. The problem is, it takes hard work and dedication. And most of the time, it's easier to let the new purchase rot in the basement or garage after a few weeks of use. That's when the garage sale comes around, and you can pick up an almost-brand-new piece of equipment at a fraction of the price for a brand-new one. Many people offer them free if you'll just haul it away and stop them from feeling guilty about their overoptimistic purchase.

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## Most furniture

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Have you ever seen *Antiques Roadshow*? Desks, chairs, shelves, bed frames,